

The global happiness index reports that people are never bored anymore, and creativity is falling. Design a product that brings boredom back, for good.

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CONFIDENTIAL

- What's truly broken in a world without boredom, and why does it matter now?
- Who are you designing for, and what need or behavior gap do they have?
- What is your product idea, and how does it bring boredom back?
- How will you design an experience that's engaging *because* it's boring?
- What does your MVP look like, and what trade-offs will you make while building it?
- What are the biggest risks or unintended consequences, and how will you mitigate them?
- What does success look like, how will you measure “boredom achieved”?



THE PROBLEM

The lack of moments of boredom is leading to a noticeable decline in creativity & reflective thinking, leaving individuals less innovative and mentally drained. This gradual erosion of creative potential and inner calm represents a pressing issue that demands immediate attention

The Creativity Crisis: The Decrease in Creative Thinking Scores on the Torrance Tests of Creative Thinking

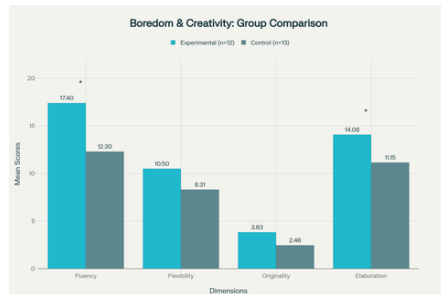
Kyung Hee Kim

Why Does it Matter?

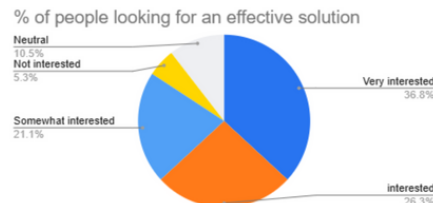
- In today's knowledge-driven economy, creativity is the ultimate differentiator
- The constant pressure to always be "always on" is leaving people stressed, anxious & mentally exhausted
- And the quiet moments we need for reflection & creativity are vanishing

Assumptions

- Restoring intentional boredom will cause, not just correlate with, higher creativity & users who achieve DMN activation will generate more ideas
- Real-time brain feedback will provide sufficient motivation for users to complete 2-week learning phase
- Future EEGs will stay accurate for DMN detection even in real-world, noisy conditions



Survey of 18 Gen Z students & professionals



WHAT'S BROKEN?



Why don't I get creative ideas anymore, even though I think very hard...

Constant stimulation has erased boredom which fuels creative thoughts



I keep switching between apps for stimulation & ideas, but my mind becomes tired

Traditional focus hacks fail
Willpower isn't enough for real stillness



I'm trying meditation apps, but nothing seems to truly help me disconnect or stay consistent

WHAT mechanism stopped working?	The brain's Default Mode Network (DMN) that enables creativity
WHY it's broken	People stay stuck in reactive mode (scroll/consume/respond) and never enter generative mode
CONSEQUENCE	Creativity, focus, emotional depth collapsing

WHY EXISTING SOLUTIONS FAIL?

	Meditation app & detox tools rely on willpower, cannot show any real-time progress to the user, leading to high drop-offs & no lasting change
	Retreats and dumbphones are too extreme for daily fast-paced life
	Screen-time limiters and blockers restrict usage but don't restore creativity or mental recovery

THE GAP

No solution exists which combines:

-  Creates intentional boredom & turns into Creativity
-  Real-time feedback & prescribes optimal boredom activity,, duration and time
-  Measures creative ideas generated
-  Provides AI- powered guidance offering customizable distraction blocking
-  Fits effortlessly into fast paced lives with gentle nudges and measurable progress

Problem

USER PERSONA

Prioritized Persona



Nandini | 32, F
UX Designer, Hyderabad
Income : ₹11 LPA
Spends 9-12 hrs screen time/day

Represents urban white-collar professionals, including knowledge workers, founders, and VPs.

Why her?

- Job involves producing original, high-quality ideas
- Willing to try (and afford) new technology promising productivity

Core Problems:

- Creative Block Despite Constant Inspiration,
- lost Ability to think Without External Stimuli
- Cognitive Overload from Always-On Culture



Rohan | 24, M, Mumbai
Gen Z Influencer
Income: ₹7 LPA+
Publishes 3-5 videos/week 12+ hrs screen time daily

Represents
YouTubers & freelancers,

Why him?

- Experiences the problem frequently
- Already spends on tech/tools
- Creator users can drive viral adoption through promotion

Core Problems:

- Inspiration Overload, Originality Crisis
- Burnout from Constant Production, Algorithm Pressure
- Failed to Regain Creativity via Existing Tools

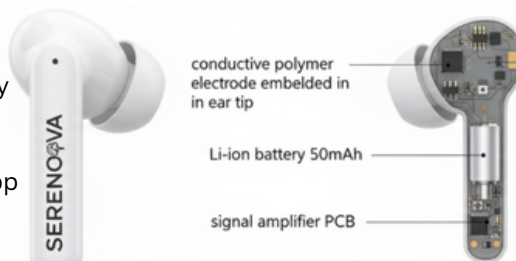
PRIORITIZATION OF PAIN POINTS & SOLUTIONS

Pain Point	Reach	Impact	Confidence	Effort	RICE Score	Solutions
Can't Generate Ideas Despite Effort	80%	3 (High)	90%	2 weeks	108	AI-powered neuro-feedback system(Serenova)
Too much mental input at once	100%	2 (Med)	80%	2 weeks	80	Digital Minimalism coaching app
Can't Tolerate Stillness	85%	2 (Med)	70%	4 weeks	30	Analog Boredom Journals with text & voice input options

PROPOSED SOLUTION

Introducing SERENOVA

- Recent researches demonstrate that ear EEG wearables can reliably monitor brain waves to detect drowsiness, proving the technology is viable for daily wearable use.
- Serenova builds on this by pairing EEG-enabled earbuds with an AI app that tracks your Default Mode Network (DMN), tests 20+ low-stimulation activities & generates a personalized boredom sessions to unlock creativity



Serenova Earbud

FEATURES



Guides users into a reflective state through real-time brain waves monitoring, letting the mind wander productively



Learns the activity, duration & timing that work best for each user by analyzing their behavior & brain responses in the first 2 weeks



Distraction blocking of apps and notifications during boredom sessions based on the user's personal preferences



Measures creative recovery and cognitive output, proving sessions are effective and showing progress over time

How Does It Bring Boredom Back?



For the first 2 weeks of usage, the app suggests a variety of boredom activities (walking, breathing, sitting still) at different times and durations



Dry EEG sensors track user's brain's signals, detecting when s/he enter the "creative idle" (DMN) state



If the user tries to end a session early, the app gently suggests that their peak creative stage is not yet arrived, encouraging them to complete the session



The system analyzes which activities and durations most reliably trigger productive boredom for user



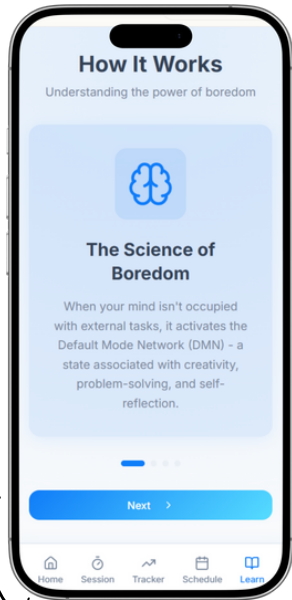
After 2 weeks, system prescribes user's ideal boredom activity & timing for creative recovery

Engaging Through Boredom

System Action	Engagement Effect
Real-time EEG visualization shows DMN activation during sessions	Replaces passive waiting with active observation where user sees proof that boredom works
System A/B tests activities/durations, then prescribes optimal boredom activity and duration	Makes user spends less time guessing & more time reaching productive boredom.
Users log creative output, mood, and stress post-session	creates positive reinforcement loop b/w boredom & creativity

USER INTERFACE

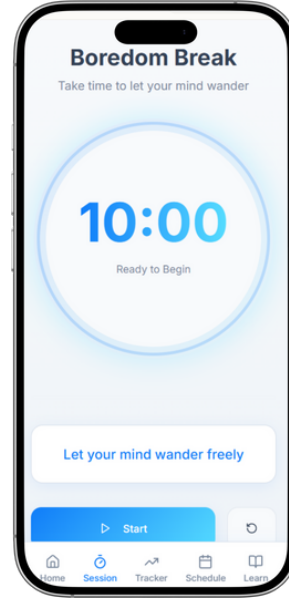
Our MVP is a neuroscience-driven iOS app paired with EEG-enabled earbuds that personalize boredom into measurable creativity



After installing, User lands on "How Boredom Improves Creativity" explainer



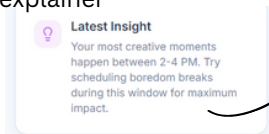
Progress bar



Progress tracker which tracks no. of sessions, no. of creative ideas generated



Shows real-time brain wave states



Personalized guidance on optimal boredom time

Solution

TRADE-OFFS

MVP	Post MVP	Why This Trade-Off
iOS app only (initial launch)	Android + web dashboard	iOS - higher early adopter density for health wearables; iPhone users (top 10%-25K/month salary) spend 20K-50K on Apple Products
2-week learning phase with manual activity testing	Automated real-time activity detection	Users need structured onboarding & automation requires more data & AI training
Bluetooth-only data sync	Cloud-based trend analysis	Privacy-first approach; cloud infrastructure can wait until user base scales
Basic boredom metrics (DMN activation time, session count)	Advanced creativity scores (idea quality, divergent thinking tests)	Simple metrics validate core hypothesis; complex scoring risks MVP scope
Manual session logging for creative output	Automated idea capture via voice/text integration	Manual logging proves causality first; automation adds technical complexity

RISKS & MITIGATION STRATEGIES

RISK MATRIX

		Severity	->
Likelihood ↓		 Hardware Cost - Partner with contract manufacturer for 1,000+ unit batches & fix prices before - Use reliable, pre-tested components to avoid technical or quality problems	 User Drop off Before 2 Weeks (as they might not believe the system, until they get some creative ideas) - Show partial personalization early (eg. from day 3) - Build excitement with progress made
		 Neurofeedback Limitations (Some people fail to achieve successful modulation because of biological differences) - Flag users with consistently poor EEG signal quality or zero DMN activation 30-day return if device doesn't detect DMN after 10 sessions, builds trust	 Privacy & Regulations - On-device processing - Transparent "your data never leaves device" policy - User data ownership - Annual third-party privacy audit - Partner with certified manufacturers - Launch in lighter regulatory markets first

SUCCESS METRICS



North Star Metric MAU with $\geq 25\%$ creativity score improvement from baseline

